



The Start Menu is translucent now

4.3 Startup and Shutdown

The final functional change is to how Windows shuts down—by default, it doesn't. Vista goes into a low-power state, wherein your work is saved to disk—the default behaviour is thus the Sleep mode as seen under XP. This has been done to reduce startup times, as it is much quicker to boot the OS from Sleep mode than a cold restart. To access the traditional Shutdown command, you need to dig a bit deeper into the menu by clicking on an arrow right next to the “Lock” icon—this reveals all the methods for powering down or locking your computer: Switch User, Log off, Lock, Restart, Sleep, and Shutdown.

Visual changes have also been made to the taskbar structure, which extends beyond the Orb. The most striking is the use of